

The GlamSquad Salon

Improving Appointment Flow and Understanding What Drives Repeat Business

Project Overview

The GlamSquad Salon is a Chennai-based salon business where appointments, service selection, customer experience and staff availability are closely connected.

The business had customer and appointment information, but the challenge was turning that information into a clearer view of how the salon was actually operating.

Which services were bringing customers in?

Which customers were coming back?

Where were appointments creating operational pressure?

Could the booking process be improved?

And which numbers should the owner actually look at regularly?

I worked on the project from a Business Analyst perspective, focusing on the appointment journey, service performance, repeat bookings and the information needed to monitor the business.

The work included understanding the existing process, identifying gaps, defining requirements, documenting the proposed improvements and designing KPIs and reporting views to support day-to-day decisions.

The Business Problem

A salon appointment looks simple from the customer's side:

Choose a service → Select a time → Visit the salon → Make payment

Operationally, there is much more happening behind that journey.

A booking depends on the requested service, available time, staff availability, expected service duration and sometimes changes or cancellations.

At the same time, the business needs answers to questions such as:

Which services are performing well?

Which customers are returning?

Are certain periods consistently busy or quiet?

Where are bookings being lost or changed?

How much business comes from repeat customers?

The problem was therefore not simply tracking appointments.

It was understanding how the booking process and customer behaviour affected the business.

My Role

I approached the engagement as a Business Analyst.

My responsibilities included:

- understanding the existing appointment process;
- reviewing how customer and service information was captured;
- mapping the current workflow;
- identifying gaps and inefficiencies;
- defining business and functional requirements;
- preparing BRD/FRD documentation;
- defining relevant business KPIs;
- analyzing service mix and appointment patterns;
- examining repeat-booking behaviour;
- designing improved process flows;
- defining reporting and dashboard requirements;
- translating business problems into practical recommendations.

A major part of the work involved asking what information the salon actually needed to make decisions rather than simply reporting every field available in the data.

Understanding the Existing Appointment Journey

I started with the current booking process.

Before suggesting improvements, I wanted to understand what happened from the moment a customer requested an appointment until the service was completed.

I broke the journey into stages such as:

Appointment Request

↓

Service Selection

↓

Slot / Staff Availability

↓

Booking Confirmation

↓

Customer Visit

↓

Service Completion

↓

Payment

↓

Repeat Booking / Follow-up

Mapping the process made it easier to identify where information was being created, where decisions were being made and where problems could occur.

It also showed that the appointment process should not be viewed separately from customer retention.

The end of one appointment can potentially become the beginning of the next booking.

AS-IS Analysis

The AS-IS analysis focused on understanding how bookings were currently handled.

I looked at:

- how appointments entered the system;
- what customer information was captured;
- how services were selected;
- how appointment availability was determined;
- how changes and cancellations were handled;
- how completed appointments were recorded;
- how repeat customers could be identified;

- how performance was reviewed.

The objective was not to redesign the process immediately.

First, I needed a clear picture of what was already happening.

That provided the baseline for identifying genuine gaps instead of assuming what the problems were.

Gap Analysis

Once the current process was mapped, I compared it with the information and control the business needed.

The gaps generally fell into three areas.

Process Visibility

It needed to be easier to understand what was happening across the appointment lifecycle rather than treating every booking as an isolated transaction.

Customer Visibility

Knowing that an appointment happened was not enough.

The business also needed to understand whether that customer returned and how frequently.

Performance Visibility

Raw appointment records did not immediately answer management questions.

The business needed a smaller set of measures that could show service demand, booking behaviour and customer retention clearly.

These gaps formed the basis of the proposed requirements.

Requirements Documentation

I translated the findings into structured business and functional requirements.

The documentation covered areas such as:

- customer information;
- appointment creation;
- service selection;

- appointment status;
- booking changes;
- cancellations;
- completed services;
- repeat bookings;
- reporting;
- KPI requirements.

One thing I paid attention to was separating a **business need** from a **system feature**.

For example:

Business need:

The salon needs to understand how many customers return after their first visit.

That is different from immediately saying:

Solution:

Build a repeat-customer dashboard.

Starting with the business requirement leaves room to determine the most appropriate solution instead of jumping directly to a feature.

Service Mix Analysis

Not every salon service contributes to the business in the same way.

Some services may generate a large number of appointments.

Others may have fewer bookings but higher value.

Certain services may also be more strongly associated with repeat visits.

I therefore looked at the service mix rather than treating all appointments equally.

The objective was to understand:

What are customers booking?

Which services contribute most to activity?

How does demand differ between services?

Are there services that could potentially support stronger repeat business?

This provided a more useful picture than simply looking at total appointment volume.

Repeat Booking Analysis

Repeat bookings were particularly important because they provided a simple way to look at customer retention.

Acquiring a customer once and keeping that customer are two different business problems.

I therefore separated new and returning customer behaviour where the available data allowed it.

This changed the question from:

“How many appointments did we receive?”

to:

“How much of our business is coming back?”

That distinction matters for a salon because repeat behaviour can indicate customer satisfaction, service preference and the strength of the customer relationship.

It can also help the business decide where follow-ups or retention efforts may be worthwhile.

Designing the TO-BE Process

After understanding the existing workflow and identifying the gaps, I designed the improved process around better information capture and visibility.

Conceptually, the TO-BE journey looked like:

Customer Request

↓

Customer Identification

↓

Service Selection

↓

Availability Check

↓

Appointment Confirmation

↓

Appointment Status Tracking

↓

Service Completion

↓

Customer History Updated

↓

Repeat Booking / Follow-up Opportunity

The important change was not simply adding more steps.

The goal was to make information captured during one appointment useful for the next business decision.

For example, completed appointment information could contribute to customer history, service analysis and repeat-booking measurement instead of remaining only as an old transaction.

KPI Framework

I then defined the measures needed to monitor the business.

The KPIs were organized around practical questions rather than dashboard categories.

Appointment Performance

How many appointments are being generated and completed?

Customer Behaviour

How much business comes from new versus returning customers?

Service Performance

Which services are receiving demand and contributing to the business?

Retention

Are customers returning after previous appointments?

Operational Performance

When is demand strongest and where could scheduling or capacity require attention?

This meant that each KPI had a clear reason for existing.

If a metric did not help answer a business question, there was little value in adding it simply because it could be calculated.

Dashboard Requirements

The reporting layer was designed to give the business a quick view of performance while still allowing individual areas to be investigated.

The main reporting areas included:

Business Overview

A quick view of appointments and overall activity.

Service Performance

A comparison of demand across different services.

Customer Analysis

New versus returning customer behaviour and customer activity.

Repeat Bookings

Visibility into retention and repeat visits.

Appointment Trends

Patterns across time that could support scheduling and operational decisions.

The purpose of the dashboard was not to replace operational judgment.

It was to make important patterns easier to see.

Turning Analysis Into Business Actions

The final part of the project was connecting the findings to decisions.

For example, if a service showed strong demand but relatively weak repeat behaviour, the next question would not simply be:

“Why is the repeat rate low?”

It would be:

“Is low repeat behaviour expected for this type of service, or does it indicate a customer-retention opportunity?”

Similarly, a quiet appointment period does not automatically mean the salon should run a promotion.

The business first needs to understand whether that period has available staff capacity, whether customers could realistically shift their appointments and whether increasing demand during that period would actually be valuable.

That is where Business Analysis becomes useful.

Data identifies the pattern.

Business context determines what should be done about it.

Business Value

The project gave The GlamSquad Salon a more structured way to think about appointments and customer behaviour.

Instead of looking only at individual bookings, the framework connected:

Customer → Appointment → Service → Completion → Customer History → Repeat Booking

This provided a stronger basis for:

- monitoring appointment performance;
- understanding service demand;
- identifying repeat customers;
- measuring retention;
- improving booking visibility;
- supporting scheduling decisions;
- identifying areas where customer follow-up could be useful.

It also created documented business and functional requirements that could support future improvements to the salon’s booking and reporting process.

Tools & Techniques

Business Analysis

Requirements Elicitation, BRD, FRD, AS-IS Analysis, TO-BE Design, Gap Analysis, Process Mapping, Functional Requirements, KPI Definition

Analytics

Appointment Analysis, Service Mix Analysis, Repeat Booking Analysis, Customer Segmentation, Trend Analysis

Reporting

Dashboard Requirements, KPI Reporting, Business Performance Monitoring

What I Learned From This Project

The most useful lesson from this engagement was that small businesses do not necessarily have simple business problems.

A salon may not have the system complexity of a bank, but appointments still involve customers, services, capacity, timing, staff and revenue.

Changing one part of that process can affect several others.

It also reinforced the importance of understanding the process before proposing a solution.

It would have been easy to start by building a dashboard.

Instead, I started with:

How does an appointment actually move through the business?

Once that was clear, it became much easier to decide what should be measured, what information was missing and what could realistically be improved.

That is what made this a Business Analysis project rather than simply a reporting exercise.

Name : Chinmayee Surwade

Email. : chinmayee.surwade@gmail.com

Linkedin : <https://www.linkedin.com/in/chinmayeesurwade>